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PARKING ASSISTANCE SYSTEM AND METHOD

Abstract

Disclosed herein is a parking assistance system including an electronic parking brake associated with at least one wheel of a vehicle, a parking brake drive circuit configured to control the electronic parking brake, and a processor configured to start braking control for maintaining a braking force applied by a main brake based on input information of a transmission gear and information of whether the vehicle is braking and stopping, wherein a duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake is shorter than or equal to a preset first time, and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released based on whether the electronic parking brake is engaged or whether a target transmission gear is changed, and it is possible to minimize an impact caused by transmission by maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake for a predetermined time when performing parking gear transmission.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

[0001] This application claims the benefit of Korean Patent Application No. 10-2024-0032823, filed on Mar. 7, 2024 in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

[0002] Embodiments of the present disclosure relate to a parking assistance system and method, and more specifically, to a parking assistance system and method, which can prevent an impact caused by transmission performed during parking.

2. Description of the Related Art

[0003] Typically, in a process of shifting, by a driver, a gear of a transmission to a P stage (parking gear) to switch a vehicle to enter a parking mode, the transmission has a function of visually displaying a target transmission gear position to the driver. Such display clearly conveys a current and anticipated state of the transmission to the driver. Then, it takes about 0.5 to 2 seconds to actually end the transmission to the P stage.

[0004] When the driver stops the vehicle for parking during the transmission process, then shifts the gear to the P stage, and immediately step off a brake pedal during the above-described time period, an impact may occur on the vehicle. Such an impact mainly occurs at the moment when the transmission to the P stage is completed, and the movement of the vehicle may be changed depending on an inclined road of a road surface and a time when the driver steps off the brake pedal. In particular, when the road surface is inclined, the vehicle may move slightly when the driver steps off the brake pedal, thereby causing the driver to more greatly feel an impact at the time of P stage engagement.

SUMMARY

[0005] Therefore, it is an aspect of the present disclosure to provide a parking assistance system and method, which are capable of automatically maintaining a braking force of a vehicle during a time between a P stage input for a transmission and the actual completion of the P stage for the transmission to prevent an impact caused by transmission occurring during parking.

[0006] Additional aspects of the disclosure will be set forth in part in the description which follows and, in part, will be obvious from the description, or may be learned by practice of the disclosure.

[0007] In accordance with one aspect of the present disclosure, a parking assistance system may include an electronic parking brake associated with at least one wheel of a vehicle, a parking brake drive circuit configured to control the electronic parking brake, and a processor configured to start braking control for maintaining a braking force applied by a main brake based on input information of a transmission gear and information of whether the vehicle is braking and stopping, wherein a duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake is shorter than or equal to a preset first time, and the processor may control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released based on whether the electronic parking brake is engaged or whether a target transmission gear is changed.

[0008] The processor may be configured to control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when engagement of the electronic parking brake is completed.

[0009] The processor may be configured to identify whether the target transmission gear is changed

to a P stage when engagement of the electronic parking brake is not completed, and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake exceeds a preset second time.

[0010] The processor may be configured to control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage, the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake does not exceed the preset second time, and engagement of the electronic parking brake is completed.

[0011] The processor may be configured to identify whether transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed when the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage, and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed.

[0012] The processor may be configured to identify whether transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed when the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage, and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is not completed and the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake exceeds the preset first time.

[0013] The processor may be configured to, when the input information of the transmission gear corresponds to a P stage, determine whether the vehicle is braking and stopping based on a signal associated with displacement of a brake pedal or a signal associated with an wheel speed.

[0014] The processor may be configured to identify whether the vehicle is on an inclined road based on a signal associated with a longitudinal acceleration.

[0015] The processor may be configured to, when it is identified that the vehicle is on the inclined road, adjust the braking force applied by the main brake based on an inclination angle of a road surface on which the vehicle is.

[0016] The preset first time may be longer than the preset second time.

[0017] In accordance with another aspect of the present disclosure, a parking assistance method may include identifying whether a driver inputs a P stage based on input information of a transmission gear, identifying whether a vehicle is braking and stopping, controlling a braking force applied by a main brake to be maintained, wherein a duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake is shorter than or equal to a preset first time and controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released based on whether an electronic parking brake associated with at least one wheel of the vehicle is engaged or whether a target transmission gear is changed.

[0018] The controlling of the braking force applied by the main brake to be released may include controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when engagement of the electronic parking brake is completed.

[0019] The parking assistance method may further include, after the identifying of whether the driver inputs the P stage, when engagement of the electronic parking brake is not completed, identifying whether the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage, identifying whether the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and a preset second time is exceeded, and controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake exceeds the preset second time.

[0020] The parking assistance method may further include controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage, the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake does not exceed the preset second time, and engagement of the electronic parking brake is completed.

[0021] The parking assistance method may further include identifying whether transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed when the target transmission gear is changed to the P

stage, and controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed.

[0022] The method may further include controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is not completed and the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake exceeds the preset first time.

[0023] The identifying of whether the vehicle is braking and stopping may include identifying whether the vehicle is braking and stopping based on a signal associated with displacement of a brake pedal or a signal associated with a wheel speed.

[0024] The method may further include identifying whether the vehicle is on an inclined road based on a signal associated with a longitudinal acceleration.

[0025] The method may further include, when the vehicle is on an inclined road, adjusting the braking force applied by the main brake based on an inclination angle of a road surface on which the vehicle is.

[0026] The preset first time may be longer than the preset second time.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0027] These and/or other aspects of the disclosure will become apparent and more readily appreciated from the following description of the embodiments, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings of which:

[0028] FIG. 1 shows a parking assistance system included in a vehicle according to one embodiment;

[0029] FIG. 2 shows hydraulic and electrical control of a main brake and an electronic parking brake according to one embodiment;

[0030] FIG. 3 shows one example of a hydraulic structure of a hydraulic device controlled by the parking assistance system according to one embodiment;

[0031] FIG. 4 shows a transmission interface of the vehicle to which the parking assistance system according to one embodiment is applied;

[0032] FIG. 5 is a flowchart showing a parking assistance method according to one embodiment; and

[0033] FIG. 6 is a flowchart more specifically showing the parking assistance method shown in FIG. 5.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0034] The same reference numbers indicate the same components throughout the specification. The present specification does not describe all elements of embodiments, and general contents or overlapping contents between the embodiments in the technical field to which the disclosure pertains will be omitted. Terms “unit,” “module,” “member,” and “block” used in the specification may be implemented as software or hardware, and according to the embodiments, a plurality of “units,” “modules,” “members,” and “blocks” may be implemented as one component, or one “unit,” “module,” “member,” and “block” may also include a plurality of components.

[0035] Throughout the specification, when a first portion is described as being “connected” to a second portion, this includes both a case in which the first portion is directly connected to the second portion and a case in which the first portion is indirectly connected to the second portion, and the indirect connection includes connection through a wireless communication network.

[0036] In addition, when a certain portion is described as “including” a certain component, this means further including other components rather than precluding other components unless especially stated otherwise.

[0037] Throughout the specification, when a first member is described as being positioned “on” a second member, this includes both a case in which the first member is in contact with the second member and a case in which other members are present between the two members.

[0038] Terms such as first and second are used to distinguish one component from another, and the components are not limited by the above-described terms.

[0039] A singular expression includes plural expressions unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

[0040] In each operation, identification symbols are used for convenience of description, and the identification symbols do not describe the sequence of each operation, and each operation may be performed in a different sequence from the specified sequence unless a specific sequence is clearly described in context.

[0041] Hereinafter, an operation principle and embodiments of the present disclosure will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings.

[0042] FIG. 1 shows a parking assistance system included in a vehicle according to one embodiment. FIG. 2 shows hydraulic and electrical control of a main brake and an electronic parking brake according to one embodiment. FIG. 3 shows one example of a hydraulic structure of a hydraulic device controlled by the parking assistance system according to one embodiment. FIG. 4 shows a transmission interface I of the vehicle to which the parking assistance system according to one embodiment is applied.

[0043] As used herein, the term ‘main brake’ refers to the primary braking system of the vehicle, also known as the service brake. The main brake is typically operated by the brake pedal and is used for slowing or stopping the vehicle during normal driving conditions. This is in contrast to the electronic parking brake, which is a separate system primarily used to keep the vehicle stationary when parked.

[0044] As shown in FIGS. 1 to 3, an electronic control unit 200 may include a controller 210 including a processor 211 and a memory 212, a motor driving circuit 220 for applying a driving current to a motor 136, a valve driving circuit 230 for applying a driving current for control of a hydraulic control unit 140, first and second hydraulic circuits 150 and 160, and a dump control unit 180, a parking brake drive circuit 240 for applying a driving current for control a parking operation of electronic parking brakes 41 and 42, and the controller 210 for controlling operations of the motor driving circuit 220, the valve driving circuit 230, and the parking brake drive circuit 240.

[0045] More specifically, the processor 211 of the controller 210 may control the main braking brake operated by the motor 136, various units connected to the valve driving circuit 230, and the electronic parking brakes 41 and 42 based on various signals received from a wheel speed sensor 10, a pedal displacement sensor 20, a longitudinal acceleration sensor 30 and pieces of transmission-related information such as input information of a transmission gear.

[0046] Components of the motor driving circuit 220, the valve driving circuit 230, the parking brake drive circuit 240, the motor 136, the hydraulic control unit 140, the first and second hydraulic circuits 150 and 160, the dump control unit 180, the electronic parking brakes 41 and 42, and the pedal displacement sensor 20 do not correspond to essential components of the electronic control unit 200, and at least some components may be omitted.

[0047] The motor 136 may include a rotational shaft provided rotatably. The motor 136 may include a rotor connected to the rotational shaft and a stator fixed to a housing. For example, the rotor may include a permanent magnet in which an N pole and an S pole are alternately disposed along an outer surface thereof, and the stator may include a plurality of teeth disposed along the outer surface of the rotor and a plurality of coils surrounding each of the plurality of teeth.

[0048] The rotor may be rotated by magnetic interaction with the stator, and the rotation of the rotor may be provided to the rotational shaft. The motor 136 may receive a driving current controlled by the motor driving circuit 220. The plurality of coils included in the stator may form magnetic fields that are rotated near the rotor by the driving current, and the rotor may be rotated

by magnetic interaction between a magnetic field of the rotor and a magnetic field of the stator.

[0049] The hydraulic control unit **140**, the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**, and the dump control unit **180** may control flow paths extending from a master cylinder **120** or a hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** to wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34**.

[0050] The hydraulic control unit **140**, the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**, and the dump control unit **180** may receive a driving current controlled by the valve driving circuit **230**. The hydraulic control unit **140**, the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**, and the dump control unit **180** may each include at least one solenoid valve that is opened or closed by the driving current. The solenoid valve may include a plunger for opening or closing the flow path, a spring for applying an elastic force to the plunger, and a coil surrounding the plunger. The coil may generate a magnetic field by the driving current, and the plunger may move against the elastic force of the spring by the magnetic field of the coil. Therefore, the solenoid valve may be opened or closed.

[0051] The first and second parking brakes **41** and **42** may each be provided with a device capable of moving a brake pad by an electro-mechanical force without a hydraulic pressure. For example, the first and second parking brakes **41** and **42** may each include a motor having a rotational shaft and a spindle reciprocated by the rotation of the rotational shaft. The spindle may reciprocate the brake pad by the rotation of the rotational shaft.

[0052] The motor included in each of the first and second parking brakes **41** and **42** may receive a driving current controlled by the parking brake drive circuit **240**. The motor included in each of the first and second parking brakes **41** and **42** may press the brake pad toward a brake disk or separate the brake pad from the brake disk by the driving current.

[0053] The pedal displacement sensor **20** may be installed near the brake pedal **50** and may measure the movement of a brake pedal **50** by a driver's braking intention. For example, the pedal displacement sensor **20** may detect a moving distance and/or moving speed from a reference position of the brake pedal **50**.

[0054] The pedal displacement sensor **20** may be electrically connected to the processor **211** and may provide an electrical signal (pedal displacement signal) corresponding to the moving distance and/or moving speed of the brake pedal **50** to the processor **211**. For example, the pedal displacement sensor **20** may be directly connected to the processor **211** via a hard wire or connected to the processor **211** via a communication network.

[0055] The motor driving circuit **220** may control the driving current supplied to the motor **136** according to a motor control signal of the processor **211**. For example, the motor driving circuit **220** may include a three-phase inverter including a plurality of switching elements for controlling the driving current supplied to the motor **136** and an inverter driver for controlling the switching elements included in the three-phase inverter according to the motor control signal of the processor **211**. The inverter driver may provide a motor driving signal for driving the three-phase inverter to the switching elements of the three-phase inverter according to the motor control signal of the processor **211**. The three-phase inverter may convert DC power supplied from a battery of the vehicle into AC power according to the motor driving signal of the inverter driver and provide the converted AC power to the motor **136**.

[0056] The valve driving circuit **230** may control the driving current supplied to the valves included in the hydraulic control unit **140**, the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**, and the dump control unit **180** according to a valve control signal of the processor **211**. For example, the valve driving circuit **230** may include switching elements for controlling the driving current supplied to the valves and switching drivers for controlling the switching elements according to the valve control signal of the processor **211**.

[0057] The parking brake drive circuit **240** may control the driving current supplied to the motors included in the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** according to parking control signals (parking engagement signal and parking disengagement signal) of the processor **211**. That is, the parking

brake drive circuit **240** may control the operations of the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** associated with at least one wheel of the vehicle based on the parking control signal of the processor **211**. For example, the parking brake drive circuit **240** may include an H-bridge circuit including a plurality of switching elements for controlling the driving current supplied to the electronic parking brake motors and an H-bridge driver for controlling the switching elements included in the H-bridge circuit according to the parking control signals of the processor **211**. [0058] The controller **210** may include the processor **211** for controlling the components included in the electronic control unit **200** and the memory **212** for storing or recording programs and data for implementing operations of controlling the components included in the electronic control unit **200**.

[0059] The memory **212** may provide the stored programs and data to the processor **211** and store temporary data generated during operation of the processor **211**. For example, the memory **212** may include, for example, volatile memories such as a static random access memory (SRAM) and a dynamic RAM (DRAM) and non-volatile memories such as a read only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable ROM (EPROM), and a flash memory.

[0060] The processor **211** may be electrically connected to the wheel speed sensor **10**, the pedal displacement sensor **20**, the longitudinal acceleration sensor **30**, an electronic transmission system **300**, the motor driving circuit **220**, the valve driving circuit **230**, and the parking brake drive circuit **240**.

[0061] The processor **211** may receive input information of the transmission gear from the electronic transmission system **300** and receive electrical signals from the wheel speed sensor **10** and the pedal displacement sensor **20**.

[0062] The processor **211** may process the electrical signals and transmission-related information received from the wheel speed sensor **10**, the pedal displacement sensor **20**, the longitudinal acceleration sensor **30** and provide the motor control signal, the valve control signal, and the parking control signal to the motor driving circuit **220**, the valve driving circuit **230**, and the parking brake drive circuit **240**, respectively, based on the result of processing the electrical signals and the transmission-related information.

[0063] For example, the processor **211** may determine a braking control mode based on input information of the transmission gear and the presence or absence of braking and stop.

[0064] The braking control mode is a type of a control mode performed by the electronic control unit **200** when preset input conditions (P stage input, braking, and stop) according to the driver's parking intention are satisfied, and means a control mode in which a braking force applied to a main braking brake according to the fact that the driver steps on the brake pedal **50** is maintained for a preset time, for example, a preset first time or a preset second time regardless of whether the driver continuously steps on the brake pedal.

[0065] When the driver shifts a gear of the transmission to the P stage (parking gear) to switch the vehicle to enter a parking mode, it takes about 0.5 to 2 seconds for the transmission to actually end the transmission to the P stage. Therefore, when the driver stops the vehicle for parking, then shifts the gear to the P stage, or at the same time, releases the brake pedal **50**, an impact may occur in the vehicle.

[0066] Therefore, the electronic control unit **200**, more specifically, the processor **211** of the controller **210** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may perform a braking control mode to prevent an impact caused by the release of the brake pedal **50** between the moment the driver presses a P stage input button and the actual transmission end time point to the P stage of the transmission.

[0067] For example, when it is determined that the current mode is the braking control mode, the processor **211** may control the braking force applied to the main braking brake to be maintained and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released based on whether the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** are engaged or whether the target transmission gear is changed.

[0068] As shown in FIG. 2, the electronic control unit **200** includes a hydraulic device **100** for generating a hydraulic pressure for braking the vehicle, and the controller **210** for controlling an operation of the hydraulic device **100**.

[0069] The hydraulic device **100** may generate the hydraulic pressure for generating a braking force to wheels **11**, **12**, **13**, and **14**. The hydraulic device **100** may detect the driver's braking intention through, for example, the brake pedal **50**. The hydraulic device **100** may generate the hydraulic pressure based on the moving distance and/or moving speed of the brake pedal **50** and provide the generated hydraulic pressure to the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34** through transfer flow paths **61**, **62**, **63**, and **64**. The transfer flow paths **61**, **62**, **63**, and **64** may include the first transfer flow path **61** connected to the first wheel cylinder **31**, the second transfer flow path **62** connected to the second wheel cylinder **32**, the third transfer flow path **63** connected to the third wheel cylinder **33**, and the fourth transfer flow path **64** connected to the fourth wheel cylinder **34**.

[0070] Internal pressures of the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34** may depend on the hydraulic pressure provided from the hydraulic device **100**. Depending on the internal pressures of the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34**, braking forces may be generated in the wheels **11**, **12**, **13**, and **14**.

[0071] As shown in FIG. 3, the hydraulic device **100** may include a reservoir **110** in which a pressing medium is stored, the master cylinder **120** for providing a driver with a reaction force according to a pressing force of the brake pedal **50** and at the same time, pressing and discharging the pressing medium such as a brake oil accommodated therein, the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** for receiving the driver's braking intention as electrical signals from the pedal displacement sensor **20** for detecting displacement of the brake pedal **50** and generating a hydraulic pressure of the pressing medium through a mechanical operation, a hydraulic control unit **140** for controlling the hydraulic pressure provided from the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130**, the hydraulic circuits **150** and **160** including the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34** for receiving the hydraulic pressure of the pressing medium to perform braking of each of the wheels **11**, **12**, **13**, and **14**, back-up flow paths **171** and **172** hydraulically connecting the master cylinder **120** with the hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**, the dump control unit **180** provided between the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** and the reservoir **110** to control a flow of the pressing medium, and an inspection flow path **190** connected to a master chamber of the master cylinder **120**.

[0072] The reservoir **110**, the master cylinder **120**, the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130**, the hydraulic control unit **140**, the hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**, the backup flow paths **171** and **172**, the dump control unit **180**, the reservoir flow paths **111** and **112**, and the inspection flow path **190** do not correspond to essential components of the hydraulic device **100**, and at least some components may be omitted.

[0073] When the driver applies the pedal force to the brake pedal **50** for a braking operation, the master cylinder **120** may provide a stable pedal feel by providing the driver with the reaction force in response to the pedal force. In addition, the master cylinder **120** may be provided to press and discharge the pressing medium accommodated therein by the operation of the brake pedal **50**.

[0074] The master cylinder **120** may include a cylinder body **121** forming a chamber therein, a first master chamber **122a** formed at an inlet side of the cylinder body **121** to which the brake pedal **50** is connected, a first master piston **122** provided in the first master chamber **122a** and connected to the brake pedal **50** to be provided to be displaced by the operation of the brake pedal **50**, a second master chamber **123a** formed inside and in front of (left side based on FIGS. 2 and 3) the first master chamber **122a**, a second master piston **123** provided in the second master chamber **123a** and provided to be displaced by the displacement of the first master piston **122** or the hydraulic pressure of the pressing medium accommodated in the first master chamber **122a**, and a pedal simulator **124** disposed between the first master piston **122** and the second master piston **123** to provide a pedal feel through an elastic restoring force generated upon compression.

[0075] The cylinder body **121**, the first master chamber **122a**, the first master piston **122**, the second master chamber **123a**, the second master piston **123**, and the pedal simulator **124** do not

correspond to essential components, and at least some components may be omitted.

[0076] The first master piston **122** and the second master piston **123** are provided in the first master chamber **122a** and the second master chamber **123a**, respectively, to generate a hydraulic pressure or a negative pressure in the pressing medium accommodated in each chamber according to the forward movement and the backward movement.

[0077] The pedal simulator **124** may be provided between the first master piston **122** and the second master piston **123** and may provide the pedal feel of the brake pedal **50** to the driver by the elastic restoring force thereof.

[0078] The reservoir **110** may accommodate and store the pressing medium therein. The reservoir **110** may be connected to each component such as the master cylinder **120**, the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130**, and a hydraulic circuit to be described below to supply or receive the pressing medium.

[0079] Reservoir flow paths **111** and **112** hydraulically connecting the reservoir **110** and the master cylinder **120** may be provided between the reservoir **110** and the master cylinder **120**. The reservoir flow paths **111** and **112** may include a first reservoir flow path **111** connecting the first master chamber **122a** of the master cylinder **120** with the reservoir **110** and a second reservoir flow path **112** connecting the second master chamber **123a** of the master cylinder **120** with the reservoir **110**. A simulator valve **112a** may be provided on the first reservoir flow path **111** so that a flow of the pressing medium between the reservoir **110** and the first master chamber **122a** through the first reservoir flow path **111** may be controlled.

[0080] The hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** may be provided to receive the driver's braking intention as the electrical signals from the pedal displacement sensor **20** for detecting the displacement of the brake pedal **50** to generate the hydraulic pressure of the pressing medium through the mechanical operation.

[0081] The hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** may include a cylinder block **131** provided to accommodate the pressing medium, a hydraulic piston **132** accommodated in the cylinder block **131**, pressure chambers **133** and **134** partitioned by the hydraulic piston **132** and the cylinder block **131**, the motor **136** for generating a rotating force, a power conversion unit **137** for converting the rotating force into the translational movement of the hydraulic piston **132**, and a driving shaft **135** for transmitting power to the hydraulic piston **132**.

[0082] The cylinder block **131**, the hydraulic piston **132**, the pressure chambers **133** and **134**, the motor **136**, the power conversion unit **137**, and the driving shaft **135** do not correspond to essential components of the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130**, and at least some components may be omitted.

[0083] The pressure chambers **133** and **134** may include the first pressure chamber **133** positioned in front (left direction of the hydraulic piston **132** based on FIG. 3) of the hydraulic piston **132** and the second pressure chamber **134** positioned behind (right direction of the hydraulic piston **132** based on FIG. 3) the hydraulic piston **132**. That is, the first pressure chamber **133** may be partitioned by the cylinder block **131** and a front surface of the hydraulic piston **132** and provided to have a volume changed depending on the movement of the hydraulic piston **132**. In addition, the second pressure chamber **134** may be partitioned by the cylinder block **131** and a rear surface of the hydraulic piston **132** and provided to have a volume changed depending on the movement of the hydraulic piston **132**.

[0084] When the displacement of the brake pedal **50** is detected by the pedal displacement sensor **20**, the hydraulic piston **132** may generate the hydraulic pressure in the first pressure chamber **133** while moving forward in the cylinder block **131**. Conversely, when the pedal force of the brake pedal **50** is released, the hydraulic piston **132** may generate the negative pressure in the first pressure chamber **133** while moving backward in the cylinder block **131**. The generation of the hydraulic pressure and the negative pressure in the second pressure chamber **134** may be implemented by an operation in an opposite direction.

[0085] As described above, the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** may generate the hydraulic pressure or the negative pressure in the first pressure chamber **133** and the second pressure chamber **134** by the motor **136**.

[0086] The hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** may be hydraulically connected to the reservoir **110** by the dump control unit **180**. The dump control unit **180** may include at least one flow path and at least one valve to control the flow of the pressing medium between the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** and the reservoir **110**.

[0087] The hydraulic control unit **140** may be provided to control the hydraulic pressure transferred to each of the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34**.

[0088] The hydraulic control unit **140** is branched into the first hydraulic circuit **150** for controlling the flows of the hydraulic pressures transferred to the first and second wheel cylinders **31** and **32** among the four wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34** and the second hydraulic circuit **160** for controlling the flows of the hydraulic pressures transferred to the third and fourth wheel cylinders **33** and **34** among the four wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34**. The hydraulic control unit **140** may include at least one flow path and at least one valve to guide the hydraulic pressure transferred from the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** to the four wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34** to the first hydraulic circuit **150** and the second hydraulic circuit **160**.

[0089] The hydraulic control unit **140** may form the flow paths for providing the pressing medium to the first hydraulic circuit **150** and the second hydraulic circuit **160** using the pressure of the first pressure chamber **133** formed by the forward movement of the hydraulic piston **132**. For example, as shown in FIG. 3, the hydraulic control unit **140** may form the flow paths connecting the first pressure chamber **133** with the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**. The pressing medium in the first pressure chamber **133** may be provided to the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160** through the hydraulic control unit **140**.

[0090] The hydraulic control unit **140** may form the flow paths for returning the pressing medium from the first hydraulic circuit **150** and the second hydraulic circuit **160** using the negative pressure of the first pressure chamber **133** formed by the backward movement of the hydraulic piston **132**. For example, as shown in FIG. 3, the hydraulic control unit **140** may form the flow paths connecting the first pressure chamber **133** with the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**. The pressing media of the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160** may be provided to the first pressure chamber **133** through the hydraulic control unit **140**.

[0091] The hydraulic control unit **140** may form the flow paths for returning the pressing medium from the first hydraulic circuit **150** and the second hydraulic circuit **160** using the negative pressure of the second pressure chamber **134** formed by the forward movement of the hydraulic piston **132**. For example, as shown in FIG. 3, the hydraulic control unit **140** may form the flow paths connecting the second pressure chamber **134** with the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160**. The pressing media of the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160** may be provided to the second pressure chamber **134** through the hydraulic control unit **140**.

[0092] The first hydraulic circuit **150** may adjust and control the hydraulic pressure applied to the first and second wheel cylinders **31** and **32**, and the second hydraulic circuit **160** may adjust and control the hydraulic pressure applied to the third and fourth wheel cylinders **33** and **34**.

[0093] The first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160** may each include two of first to fourth inlet valves **151a**, **151b**, **161a**, and **161b** to control the flow and hydraulic pressure of the pressing medium transferred to the first to fourth wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34**. The first to fourth inlet valves **151a**, **151b**, **161a**, and **161b** may each be disposed at an upstream side of each of the first to fourth wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34** and provided as normal open type solenoid valves.

[0094] The second hydraulic circuit **160** may include first and second outlet valves **162a** and **162b** for controlling the flow of the pressing medium discharged from the third and fourth wheel cylinders **33** and **34** to improve performance when the braking of the third and fourth wheel cylinders **33** and **34** is released. The first and second outlet valves **162a** and **162b** may each be

provided at a discharge side of each of the third and fourth wheel cylinders **33** and **34** and may control the flows of the pressurizing medium transferred from the third and fourth wheel cylinders **33** and **34** to the reservoir **110**. The first and second outlet valves **162a** and **162b** may be provided as normally closed type solenoid valves.

[0095] The first hydraulic circuit **150** may include a third outlet valve **152a** for controlling the flow of the pressing medium discharged from the first wheel cylinder **31** to improve performance when the braking of the first wheel cylinder **31** is released. The third outlet valve **152a** may be provided at the discharge side of the first wheel cylinder **31** to control the flow of the pressing medium transferred from the first wheel cylinder **31** to the reservoir **110**. The third outlet valve **152a** may be provided as a normally closed type solenoid valve.

[0096] The second wheel cylinder **32** of the first hydraulic circuit **150** may be connected to the first backup flow path **171**, and a first cut valve **171a** may be provided on the first backup flow path **171** to control the flow of the pressing medium between the second wheel cylinder **32** and the master cylinder **120**.

[0097] The first backup flow path **171** may be provided to connect the first master chamber **122a** of the master cylinder **120** with the first hydraulic circuit **150**, and the second backup flow path **172** may be provided to connect the second master chamber **123a** of the master cylinder **120** with the second hydraulic circuit **160**.

[0098] At least one first cut valve **171a** for controlling the flow of the pressing medium in both directions may be provided on the first backup flow path **171**, and a second cut valve **172a** for controlling the flow of the pressing medium in both directions may be provided on the second backup flow path **172**. The first cut valve **171a** and the second cut valve **172a** may be provided as normal open type solenoid valves.

[0099] When the first and second cut valves **171a** and **172a** are closed, the pressing medium of the master cylinder **120** can be prevented from being directly transferred to the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34**, and at the same time, the hydraulic pressure provided from the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** can be prevented from leaking toward the master cylinder **120**. In addition, when the first and second cut valves **171a** and **172a** are opened, the pressing medium pressed in the master cylinder **120** may be directly supplied toward the first and second hydraulic circuits **150** and **160** through the first and second backup flow paths **171** and **172** to implement braking.

[0100] The inspection flow path **190** may be provided to connect the master cylinder **120** with the dump control unit **180** and provided to inspection whether various components mounted on the master cylinder **120** and the simulator valve **112a** leak.

[0101] The hydraulic device **100** may include a first pressure sensor **PS1** for measuring the hydraulic pressure of the pressing medium provided by the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** and a second pressure sensor **PS2** for measuring the hydraulic pressure provided by the master cylinder **120**. The first pressure sensor **PS1** and the second pressure sensor **PS2** may output electrical signals representing the measured pressures to the controller **210**.

[0102] The controller **210**, specifically, the processor **211** of the controller **210** may control the operation of the hydraulic device **100**. For example, the controller **210** may control the hydraulic pressure supply unit **130** to generate the hydraulic pressure based on the output of the pedal displacement sensor **20**.

[0103] For example, the processor **211** may determine a target hydraulic pressure to be provided to the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34** based on the pedal displacement signal of the pedal displacement sensor **20** and provide the motor control signal to the motor driving circuit **220** to move the hydraulic piston **132** in response to the target pressure.

[0104] For example, the processor **211** may provide the motor control signal to the motor driving circuit **220** to move the hydraulic piston **123** forward and provide the valve control signal to the valve driving circuit **230** to form the flow paths extending from the first pressure chamber **133** to the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34**. In addition, the processor **211** may provide the motor

control signal to the motor driving circuit **220** to move the hydraulic piston **123** backward and provide the valve control signal to the valve driving circuit **230** to form the flow paths extending from the second pressure chamber **134** to the wheel cylinders **31**, **32**, **33**, and **34**.

[0105] In this case, when the current mode is determined as the braking control mode based on input information of the transmission gear and the presence or absence of braking and stop, the processor **211** may control the hydraulic device **100** to maintain the braking force applied to the main braking brake.

[0106] In the electronic control unit **200** according to one embodiment, when it is determined that the current mode is the braking control mode, the processor **211** of the controller **210** starts the braking control mode.

[0107] When starting the braking control mode, the processor **211** controls the valve driving circuit **230** to allow the hydraulic control unit **140** to maintain the braking force applied to the main braking brake regardless of whether the brake pedal **50** is released.

[0108] After starting the braking control mode, the processor **211** determines whether to end the braking control mode based on two conditions.

[0109] One is whether the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** have been engaged, and the other is whether the transmission gear is changed to the P stage for the preset first time. However, here, when the preset first time is exceeded even when the transmission gear is not changed to the P stage, the braking control may be released, that is, the braking control mode may be ended.

[0110] The processor **211** monitors whether the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** have been engaged in real time while performing the braking control mode. The processor **211** may end the braking control mode when the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** have been engaged regardless of other variables in a braking control mode state, such as the target transmission gear and whether the transmission gear is changed to the P stage. Here, when the braking control mode is ended, it means that the main braking brake is allowed to be operated according to whether the driver steps on the brake pedal **50** by performing hydraulic control to cancel the braking force applied to the main braking brake.

[0111] The reason why the braking control mode is ended as the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** have been engaged is that the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** are actually engaged (e.g., a state in which parking is ended), and thus there is no need to maintain the braking force applied to the main braking brake.

[0112] However, even when the processor **211** starts the braking control mode, the maximum time at which the braking control mode is maintained may be set not to exceed the preset first time.

[0113] Here, the first time may be 3 seconds.

[0114] When the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** have not been engaged, the processor **211** may identify whether the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage. To this end, the processor **211** may receive input information of the transmission gear from the electronic transmission system **300** in real time.

[0115] When the driver inputs the gear stage to be shifted to the transmission interface I, the target transmission gear indicates a gear stage at the time when the electronic transmission system **300** actually recognizes the input of the gear stage input into the transmission interface I.

[0116] For example, when the driver inputs the P (parking) stage into the transmission interface I to stop or park the vehicle at a D (driving) stage, the electronic transmission system **300** actually recognizes the P stage as the target transmission gear.

[0117] When the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and the preset second time is exceeded, the processor **211** may control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released. A slight delay is caused by signal transmission until the gear stage input to the transmission interface I is actually recognized by the electronic transmission system **300**. The preset second time may be set to 0.5 seconds in consideration of such a delay time.

[0118] The reason why whether the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage is checked as

described above is that there is no need to continuously perform the braking control mode in a case where the input stage signal is not transmitted from the transmission interface I to the electronic transmission system **300** due to a failure of an in-vehicle communication interface such as controller area network (CAN) communication, or a case where the driver inputs the P stage into the transmission interface I and then immediately re-inputs another stage (D, N, or R).

[0119] When the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage, the preset second time is not exceeded, and engagement of the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** is completed, the processor **211** may control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released. That is, as described above, since the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** are actually engaged (e.g., the state in which parking is ended) and there is no need to maintain the braking force applied to the main braking brake, the processor **211** may end the braking control mode.

[0120] When the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage, the processor **211** may identify whether the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed, and when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed, control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (end the braking control mode). The processor **211** identifies that the target transmission gear of the electronic transmission system **300** is changed to the P stage by checking that input information of the transmission gear received from the electronic transmission system **300** is changed to the P stage. Subsequently, when the processor **211** receives P stage transmission end information according to the end of the transmission of the P stage of the transmission gear from the electronic transmission system **300**, the processor **211** identifies that the transmission of the P stage of the transmission gear is completed and controls the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (cancel the braking control mode).

[0121] Here, when the preset first time is exceeded in a state in which the processor **211** does not receive the P stage transmission end information from the electronic transmission system **300**, the processor **211** controls the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (cancel the braking control mode). The reason why the braking control mode is ended when the preset first time is exceeded in the state in which the transmission to the P stage is not completed is as follows. It is because there may be no need to continuously perform the braking control mode due to various variables inside the vehicle. For example, the variable may include a case where the communication interface inside the vehicle, such as CAN communication, fails, a case where the driver inputs the P stage into the transmission interface I and then immediately re-inputs another gear stage (D, N, or R), etc. That is, in a situation where the braking control mode needs to be actually ended due to the occurrence of a certain variable, the conditions in which the braking control mode is ended may not be recognized. Therefore, to prevent the braking control mode from being maintained unnecessarily, the preset first time may be set to an additional braking control mode cancel condition.

[0122] Here, the preset first time may be 3 seconds.

[0123] The processor **211** may receive input information of the transmission gear from the transmission interface I or the electronic transmission system **300** shown in FIG. 4.

[0124] When input information of the transmission gear is the P stage, the processor **211** may determine whether the vehicle is braking and stopping based on a signal associated with displacement of the brake pedal **50** and/or a signal associated with a wheel speed.

[0125] The processor **211** may identify whether the vehicle is on an inclined road based on a signal associated with a longitudinal acceleration.

[0126] In this case, the processor **211** may identify whether the vehicle is on the inclined road based on the signal associated with the longitudinal acceleration received from the longitudinal acceleration sensor **30**. However, the present disclosure is not limited thereto, and whether the vehicle is on the slop may be identified using another detection device.

[0127] When the vehicle is on the inclined road, the processor **211** may adjust the braking force applied by the main brake based on an inclination angle of a road surface.

[0128] For example, the processor **211** may control a braking force greater than the braking force applied by the main brake to be applied in proportion to the inclination angle as the inclination angle of the road surface increases, that is, as the inclined road becomes steeper.

[0129] FIG. **5** is a flowchart showing a parking assistance method according to one embodiment.

[0130] As shown in FIG. **5**, the parking assistance method according to one embodiment of the present disclosure may include identifying whether the driver inputs the P stage based on input information of the transmission gear (**1100**), identifying whether the vehicle is braking and stopping (**1200**), controlling the braking force applied to the main braking brake to be maintained when the driver inputs the P stage and the vehicle is braking and stopping (**1300**), and controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released based on whether the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** have been engaged or the target transmission gear is changed (**1400**).

[0131] In the identifying of whether the driver inputs the P stage (**1100**), when input information of the transmission gear is the P stage, the identifying of whether the vehicle is braking and stopping (**1200**) may include determining whether the vehicle is braking and stopping based on the signal associated with displacement of the brake pedal or the signal associated with a wheel speed.

[0132] Here, a duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake may be shorter than or equal to the preset first time.

[0133] FIG. **6** is a flowchart more specifically showing the parking assistance method shown in FIG. **5**.

[0134] In the parking assistance method according to one embodiment of the present disclosure, specific additional operations between the controlling of the braking force applied to the main braking brake to be maintained (**1300**) and the controlling of the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (**1400**) are shown in FIG. **6**.

[0135] In the controlling of the braking force applied to the main braking brake to be maintained (**1300**), whether the vehicle is on the inclined road may be determined based on the signal associated with the longitudinal acceleration.

[0136] When it is determined that the vehicle is on the inclined road, the braking force applied by the main brake may be adjusted based on the inclination angle of the road surface.

[0137] After the controlling of the braking force applied to the main braking brake to be maintained (**1300**), the method may further include identifying whether the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** have been engaged. In this case, when engagement of the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** is completed, the method may proceed to the controlling of the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (**1400**).

[0138] After the controlling of the braking force applied to the main braking brake to be maintained (**1300**), when engagement of the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** is not completed, the method may further include identifying whether the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage (**1340**) and identifying whether the target transmission gear is not to the P stage and the preset second time is exceeded (**1380**).

[0139] In the identifying of whether the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and the preset second time is exceeded (**1380**), when the preset second time is exceeded, the method may proceed to the controlling of the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (**1400**).

[0140] In the identifying of whether the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and the preset second time is exceeded (**1380**), when the preset second time is not exceeded and engagement of the electronic parking brakes **41** and **42** is completed, the method may proceed to the controlling of the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (**1400**).

[0141] After the identifying whether the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage (**1340**), when the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage, the method may further include identifying whether the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed (**1360**).

[0142] In the identifying of whether the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is

completed (1360), when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed, the method may proceed to the controlling of the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (1400).

[0143] In the identifying of whether the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed (1360), when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is not completed and the preset first time is exceeded, the method may proceed to the controlling of the braking force applied by the main brake to be released (1400).

[0144] As is apparent from the above description, it is possible to provide a parking assistance system and method, which can automatically maintain a braking force of a vehicle during the time between a P stage input for a transmission to the actual completion of the P stage for the transmission.

[0145] Therefore, according to the parking assistance system and method, it is possible to minimize the occurrence of the impact regardless of whether a driver steps on a brake pedal when switching the vehicle to enter a parking mode.

[0146] The above description is merely the exemplary description of the technical spirit of the present disclosure, and those skilled in the art to which the present disclosure pertains will be able to variously modify and change the present disclosure without departing from the essential characteristics of the present disclosure. Therefore, the embodiments disclosed in the present disclosure are not intended to limit the technical spirit of the present disclosure, but intended to describe the same, and the scope of the technical spirit of the present disclosure is not limited by these embodiments. The scope of the present disclosure should be construed by the appended claims, and all technical spirits within the equivalent range should be construed as being included in the scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A parking assistance system comprising: an electronic parking brake associated with at least one wheel of a vehicle; a parking brake drive circuit configured to control the electronic parking brake; and a processor configured to: start braking control for maintaining a braking force applied by a main brake based on input information of a transmission gear and information of whether the vehicle is braking and stopping, wherein a duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake is shorter than or equal to a preset first time; and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released based on whether the electronic parking brake is engaged or whether a target transmission gear is changed.
2. The parking assistance system of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when engagement of the electronic parking brake is completed.
3. The parking assistance system of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to: identify whether the target transmission gear is changed to a P stage when engagement of the electronic parking brake is not completed; and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake exceeds a preset second time.
4. The parking assistance system of claim 3, wherein the processor is configured to control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage, the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake does not exceed the preset second time, and engagement of the electronic parking brake is completed.
5. The parking assistance system of claim 3, wherein the processor is configured to: identify whether transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed when the target

transmission gear is changed to the P stage; and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed.

6. The parking assistance system of claim 3, wherein the processor is configured to: identify whether transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed when the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage; and control the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is not completed and the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake exceeds the preset first time.

7. The parking assistance system of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to, when the input information of the transmission gear corresponds to a P stage, determine whether the vehicle is braking and stopping based on a signal associated with displacement of a brake pedal or a signal associated with an wheel speed.

8. The parking assistance system of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to identify whether the vehicle is on an inclined road based on a signal associated with a longitudinal acceleration.

9. The parking assistance system of claim 8, wherein the processor is configured to, when it is determined that the vehicle is on the inclined road, adjust the braking force applied by the main brake based on an inclination angle of a road surface on which the vehicle is.

10. The parking assistance system of claim 3, wherein the preset first time is longer than the preset second time.

11. A parking assistance method parking brake drive comprising: identifying whether a driver inputs a P stage based on input information of a transmission gear; identifying whether a vehicle is braking and stopping; controlling a braking force applied by a main brake to be maintained, wherein a duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake is shorter than or equal to a preset first time; and controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released based on whether an electronic parking brake associated with at least one wheel of the vehicle is engaged or whether a target transmission gear is changed.

12. The parking assistance method of claim 11, wherein the controlling of the braking force applied by the main brake to be released comprises controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when engagement of the electronic parking brake is completed.

13. The parking assistance method of claim 11, further comprising: after the identifying of whether the driver inputs the P stage, when engagement of the electronic parking brake is not completed, identifying whether the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage; identifying whether the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and a preset second time is exceeded; and controlling the braking force of the main brake to be released when the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage and the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake exceeds the preset second time.

14. The parking assistance method of claim 13, further comprising controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the target transmission gear is not changed to the P stage, the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake does not exceed the preset second time, and engagement of the electronic parking brake is completed.

15. The parking assistance method of claim 13, further comprising: identifying whether transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed when the target transmission gear is changed to the P stage; and controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is completed.

16. The parking assistance method of claim 15, further comprising controlling the braking force applied by the main brake to be released when the transmission to the P stage of the transmission gear is not completed and the duration of the braking control for maintaining the braking force applied by the main brake exceeds the preset first time.

- 17.** The parking assistance method of claim 11, wherein, the identifying of whether the vehicle is braking and stopping comprises identifying whether the vehicle is braking and stopping based on a signal associated with displacement of a brake pedal or a signal associated with a wheel speed.
- 18.** The parking assistance method of claim 11, further comprises identifying whether the vehicle is on an inclined road based on a signal associated with a longitudinal acceleration.
- 19.** The parking assistance method of claim 11, further comprising, when the vehicle is on an inclined road, adjusting the braking force applied the main brake based on an inclination angle of a road surface on which the vehicle is.
- 20.** The parking assistance method of claim 13, wherein the preset first time is longer than the preset second time.
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